Yang Wu

5277863@gmail.com | yangwu15.github.io | Bluesky: Yang Wu | LinkedIn: Yang Wu |

Education

B.S. in Mathematics & B.A. in Music Composition 2023 – 2027
Soochow University — GPA: 3.9/4.0 Taipei City, Taiwan

Neuropsychiatric Disorder Summer Associate School 2024
National Taiwan University & International Brain Research Organization Taipei City, Taiwan

Cognitive Neuroscience Summer School 2024
National Central University Taoyuan City, Taiwan

Undergraduate coursework in Music (Piano Performance) 2022 – 2023
Florida State University Tallahassee, FL, USA

Research Experience

James Whittington lab, University of Oxford 2025/7 – Present
Mentors: James Whittington & Joseph Warren

- Flexible cognitive map building, without synaptic plasticity: Identified a neural algorithm that organises sequence memory dynamically, thereby generalising a loop-based sequential predictive task. After learning from just 8 loop lengths, the model reaches > 0.99 accuracy to 8 other never-seen-before loop lengths.
- Neural algorithm: When inferring the underlying loop length, the Prefrontal Cortex (PFC) model dynamically re-partition its neural space to provide a sufficient number of neural subspaces, each storing one memory of the loop, thereby correctly infer the loop length every time.
- Manuscript under review for COSYNE 2027, first-author preprint in preparation.

Marcelo Mattar lab, New York University 2025/7 – Present
Mentors: Marcelo Mattar & Daniel Levenstein (Yale)

- Do theta sweeps on an emerged cognitive map help? (with Daniel Levenstein): RNN that learns to predict upcoming sensory signals naturally develop a cognitive map. We couple it with a GRU, to test the functionality of theta sweep and goal-directed sweep on such an emerged cognitive map.
- Episodic simulation through memory recombination: meta-train GRU with key-value memory module on a three-phase navigation task (encode motor commands (e.g. move forward for 5 steps, go left for 3 steps) as memories → combining motor commands to form navigation plans → execute plan to get to the goal) to model how past memories are recombined to plan.

Kanaka Rajan lab, Harvard University 2025/7 – 2025/12
Mentor: Ryan Badman

- Interpreting planning-like behavior in naturalistic foraging RL agents: Extended the decoders analysis on model-free RL agents from PPO-GRU to a PQN-LSTM architecture, showing its hidden state predicts where the agent will move over the next 10-30 steps beyond what its position and recent movement predict.
- Methods: per-neuron GLMs (NeMoS); linear decoders of past and future position; sparse autoencoders on hidden states, matched to behavioural data.
- Deep RL Needs Deep Behavior Analysis (NeurIPS 2025; acknowledged in the paper)

Yu-Wei Wu lab, Academia Sinica 2024/7 – 2025/7
Mentor: Yu-Wei Wu

- Decomposing inter-regional neural dynamics during cued reaching in mice: Applied Current-Based Decomposition (CURBD) to model inter-regional communication from neural activity recorded in M1, M2, and S1.
- CURBD reproduced our M1/M2/S1 recordings yet could not identify the inter-regional currents from our dataset with only one cued reaching scenario; a useful negative result on the data requirements of CURBD.

Yu-Te Wang lab, Academia Sinica 2024/2 – 2025/3
Mentor: Yu-Te Wang

- EMG gesture detection & LLM music generation as feedback loop for remote-rehabilitation: Classified 8 gestures using CNN from 3-channel EMG; Developed pipeline of real-time LLM music generation based on the rehabilitation gestures detected from EMG.
- A new type of EEG Electrodes: Collected human EMG/EEG/SSVEPs data; Helped build watermill-like EEG electrodes that better reach human scalp through various hairstyles.
- Publications & Presentations in IEEE journal, SfN, IEEE workshop, National Conference

Publications & Presentations

[**5**] **A neural mechanism for dynamic structuring of memories during schema inference**
Under review for COSYNE 2027, in preparation for preprint 2026
Yang Wu, Joseph Warren, James Whittington

[4] 3D printed watermill-like semi-dry electrodes for BCI applications
IEEE Transactions on Neural Systems and Rehabilitation Engineering 2026
Chi-Ming Chung, Ching-Hung Tsai, Yu-Lin Chu, Chih-Hao Hsu, Jui-Bang Lu, Yun-Chieh Hsu, Yu-Jung Su, **Yang Wu**, Cian-Fong Hung, Yu-Te Wang

[**3**] **HCI Technologies in rehabilitation: enhancing physical therapy with EMG, VR and LLM-Generated music**
Poster, Society for Neuroscience Annual Meeting 2024
Yang Wu*, Yu-Jung Su, Jui-Bang Lu, Yu-Te Wang*, Tong-Hou Cheong

[**2**] **RehabVerse: Mixed Reality Solution for Telerehabilitation**
Poster, National Biotechnology Research Park Pitch Day 2024
Yang Wu*, Yu-Jung Su, Jui-Bang Lu, Yi-Huan Chen, Yu-Te Wang*

[1] BrainPrint: Innovative Head-Mounted EEG Technology for Secure Personal Identification
Poster, IEEE Brain Discovery & Neurotechnology Workshop 2024
Yu-Lin Chu, Ching-Chih Tsao, Chi-Ming Chung, Cian-Fong Hung, Yao-Yu Lee, Jui-Bang Lu, **Yang Wu**, Yi-Huan Chen, Yu-Te Wang*

Awards, Grants & Extracurricular

Ministry of Education Study Abroad Programme for Future Scholars in Humanities and Social Sciences (US$50,000) 2026
Computational and Systems Neuroscience (COSYNE) Conference Undergraduate Travel Grant (US$1,500) 2025
Chu-Chin Hsu Scholar 2025
Dean's List (Academic Excellence Award) × 3 2024 – 2025
Finalist, National Biomedical Engineering Award (BrainPrint) 2024
Distinction Award, International ICT Innovation Services Award (BrainPrint) 2024
National Science and Technology Council Neuroscience Camp 2024
Academia Sinica Statistical Science Camp 2024

Courses & Skills

Selected Courses (grades on 100-point scale): **Computational Neuroscience (Grad Level) 95**, **Statistical Mechanics (Grad Level) 87**, **Advanced Calculus (Real Analysis) 99**, Linear Algebra 96, Programming in Life Science 97, Life Science (Physiology) 95.

Skills: **Data collection (EEG, EMG, SSVEPs)**; Python; Bayesian inference; Deep learning (PyTorch, RNNs, Transformers); Reinforcement learning (model-free and model-based, PPO, GRPO); Statistical modeling (GLMs, sparse autoencoders, linear decoders); Tools (Git, Blender, MATLAB, 3D printing).

References

James Whittington; University of Oxford; james.whittington@psy.ox.ac.uk

Marcelo Mattar; New York University; mm13100@nyu.edu

Daniel Levenstein; Yale University; daniel.levenstein@yale.edu

Yu-Wei Wu; Academia Sinica; wuyuwei@gate.sinica.edu.tw

Yu-Te Wang; Academia Sinica; yutewang@citi.sinica.edu.tw

Music

Milonga — Latin-American piece for Cello and Piano. vimeo.com/1036267350

Zhang Beihai said goodbye to his father — Solo Piano. vimeo.com/1036267291

Weathering With You Movie Trailer (Re-score). vimeo.com/1036267308